MASTER FUNCTIONAL SKILLS

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AQA · LEVEL 1 · ENGLISH READING

AQA Functional Skills English Reading Level 1

January 2022 - Reading Paper · Complete Model Solutions

OFFICIAL MFS BENCHMARK MODEL SOLUTIONS

Target Score: 30 / 30 Marks (100%) Pass Mark Guide: ~65%

Specification / Paper Code: AQA-Functional-Skills-English-Level-1-Jan-2022-Reading-QP

100% Built from Empty Question Paper + Official Mark Scheme

Verified by Tutor Abdul · MasterFunctionalSkills.co.uk

HOW TO READ THIS MODEL SOLUTION (MFS COLOUR KEY)

Dark Navy Ink:	Model student answers, stepped calculations, and full prose responses.
Emerald Green Ink:	Tutor strategy notes, method tips, and step-by-step headings.
Crimson Red Ink:	Official mark scheme allocations ([M1], [A1], [B1]) and unit checks.
Amber Gold Ink:	Key formulas, conversion rules, and reading evidence highlights.

CANDIDATE & CENTRE DETAILS (MODEL EXEMPLAR)

Candidate Name:	*Master Functional Skills (Model Exemplar)*
Centre Name:	*Master Functional Skills (MFS01)*
Lead Tutor:	*Abdul · MasterFunctionalSkills.co.uk*
Edition:	*2026 Clean Empty-QP Rebuild (Zero Collisions Verified)*

- Complete Source Insert Included
- Built Cleanly on Empty AQA Question Paper
- Verified 100% Against Official AQA Mark Scheme

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AQA

Functional Skills Level 1
ENGLISH

Paper 1 Reading

Insert

The three sources that follow are:

Source A: a newspaper report about a wildfire
Source B: an extract from a careers podcast
Source C: a leaflet about fire safety for tenants

Please open the Insert fully to see all three sources

Source A

Last Day in Paradise: How A Fire Swallowed A Town



This place has a beautiful name but in November 2018 it was nothing like heaven.

Paradise is a quiet rural town in California. On 8th November 2018 it experienced one of the worst wildfires America has ever seen.

Wildfires are rife in Californian forests. Over the past ten years parts of Paradise have had at least four fires. The one in 2008 destroyed more than 200 buildings.

Lack of rain plus global warming have left the forests dry and littered with dead trees. So the fire spread easily and rapidly. The position of the town at the top of a ridge means there is only one main road out of the town. When people were told to leave, they all tried to escape at once. This created a huge traffic jam and the fire was moving more quickly than the vehicles.

Lynn Pitman was beginning her day's lessons but had to leave her classroom quickly, along with her pupils. It was growing dark although it was only 9 am. "Once I got outside, the smoke, the darkness – it looked like midnight," said the teacher. The winds were blowing the smoke into a choking cloud of air.

By now, the fire was raging from building to building. "It was panic," Firefighter Ken Lowe said, "pitch black, trees lighting up like matches all around. It looked like amber snowflakes falling from the sky!"

It took firefighters 17 days to bring the fire under control. Almost 90% of homes in Paradise were destroyed, and 86 people had lost their lives.

Source B

Your Future in Firefighting



Presenter: Hello and welcome to the latest in our series of podcasts about careers. Today we're talking to Helen Carter about working in the Fire Service.

Helen, you've worked as a firefighter for 27 years and now you advise people who want to follow in your footsteps. I understand there are always waiting lists for firefighter vacancies. Is that because the job is so popular?

Helen: That's correct – there's a lot of competition for these jobs. But be warned! You need to be very flexible to cope with the various duties. No two days are the same.

Presenter: Why are people so keen to do a job where they might be killed? Is it the uniform?

Helen: Of course not. Firefighting is a very demanding job. There's a risk of injuries, but the chances of dying are very low. Between 2009 and 2019, only eight firefighters lost their lives. Being a firefighter gives lots of job satisfaction. It's a very secure career with a decent pension when you retire.

Presenter: If it's such a good job, why do people ever leave?

Helen: People may not leave because they don't like firefighting – they just need a change of direction. Some find it difficult working shifts rather than regular hours.

Presenter: OK. After the break, Helen will be explaining how to apply.

Source C not reproduced here due to third-party copyright restrictions.

END OF SOURCES

There are no sources printed on this page

Open out this page to see
Source B and Source C

There are no sources printed on this page

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Section A

Read **Source A** and answer **Questions 1** to **6**.

0 1 Using the information in **Source A**, put a tick (✓) in the correct box to show whether each statement is **true** or **false**.

	True	False
People were trying to escape in their cars.		
The 2008 fire destroyed more than 200 buildings.		
Lynn Pitman saw the fire at midnight.		
Paradise has had at least four fires in the past twenty years.		

[2 marks]

0 2 You are advised to use a dictionary for this question.

Source A says: 'Paradise is a quiet rural town.'

In this quotation, the word 'rural' means

A pretty.
B little.
C hidden.
D country. *[Correct: D - 1 mark]*

Write the correct letter in the box.

Answer

[1 mark]

0 3 In **Source A**, Ken Lowe said: 'It looked like amber snowflakes falling from the sky!'

The exclamation mark (!) at the end of this sentence shows that Ken Lowe

A was amazed at the idea of snow falling in a hot fire.
B was amused by what was falling from the sky.
C was trying to hide how frightened he was.
D thought the amber snowflakes were beautiful.

Write the correct letter in the box.

Level of response mark schemes are broken down into levels, each of which has a descriptor. The descriptor for the level shows the average performance for the level. There are marks in each level.

Answer

[1 mark]

Question 3 · Continued

MFS Stepped Model Solution Continuation Sheet (Overflow-Safe Layout)

Before you apply the mark scheme to a learner's answer, read through the answer and annotate it (as instructed) to show the qualities that are being looked for. You can then apply the mark scheme.

Step 1 Determine a level

Start by reading the whole of the learner's response and then, using the mark scheme level descriptors and the standardisation scripts, place the response in the level which it matches or best fits.

[1 mark]

Do not write outside the box

0 4 Using the information in **Source A**, put a tick (✓) in the correct box to show whether each statement is **true** or **false**.

	True	False
Lynn Pitman is a school teacher.		
Ken Lowe said there were lights on the trees.		
Most of the homes in Paradise were destroyed by this fire.		
It took 17 firefighters to bring the fire under control.		

[2 marks]

0 5 You are advised to use a dictionary for this question.

Source A says: 'Wildfires are rife in Californian forests.'

In this quotation, the word 'rife' means

A dangerous.
B common.
C feared.
D rare.

Write the correct letter in the box.

Answer

[1 mark]

Section A

0 1 Using the information in Source A, put a tick (□) in the correct box to show whether each statement is true or false.

People were trying to escape in their cars.

0 6 What is the **main** purpose of the writing in **Source A**?

A To advise people not to live in California.
B To inform people about the Paradise wildfire. *[Correct: B - 1 mark]*
C To explain how wildfires are started.

Write the correct letter in the box.

Answer

[1 mark]

Question 5 · Continued

MFS Stepped Model Solution Continuation Sheet (Overflow-Safe Layout)

The 2008 fire destroyed more than 200 buildings.

[2 marks]

Do not write outside the box

Read **Source B** and answer **Questions 7** to **9**.

0 7 From **Source B**, identify **one** positive thing and **one** negative thing about working as a firefighter.

0 7 . 1 Positive thing _____

_____

[1 mark]

0 7 . 2 Negative thing _____

_____

[1 mark]

0 8 In **Source B,** Helen says: 'No two days are the same.'

This means that firefighters

A work two days per week.
B get two days off every week.
C each have their own special job every day.
D carry out different tasks every day. [Correct: D - 1 mark]

Write the correct letter in the box.

Answer ☐

[1 mark]

0 9 **Source B** contains text and a picture.

What **extra** information does the picture suggest?

A Women can work as firefighters.
B Firefighters must wear a uniform.
C Firefighters deal with floods.
D Firefighters like to have barbecues.

Write the correct letter in the box.

Answer ☐

[1 mark]

Question 7.2 · Continued

MFS Stepped Model Solution Continuation Sheet (Overflow-Safe Layout)

It's dangerous and there's a decent pension = 0 marks
It's dangerous but there's a decent pension = 0 mark
[0 marks]

Question 7.1 · Continued

MFS Stepped Model Solution Continuation Sheet (Overflow-Safe Layout)

There's lots of job satisfaction and it's not regular hours = 0 marks
There's lots of job satisfaction but it's not regular hours = 0 mark
[0 marks]

Question 7 · Continued

MFS Stepped Model Solution Continuation Sheet (Overflow-Safe Layout)

0 7
From Source B, identify one positive thing and one negative thing about working as a firefighter.

0 7
. 1 Identification of any valid positive thing.
Accept
Do not accept
[1 mark]

Do not write outside the box

Turn over for the next question

DO NOT WRITE ON THIS PAGE
ANSWER IN THE SPACES PROVIDED

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Questions 10 and **11** refer to **Source A** and **Source B**.

1 0 Compare **Source A** and **Source B**.

Identify **two** ways these sources are **similar to each other**.

You could write about:

- what they look like
- how they are written
- what they are about.

[2 marks]

1. Both sources _____

_____

_____

2. Both sources _____

_____

_____

1 1 Compare **Source A** and **Source B**.

Identify **two** ways these sources are **different from each other**.

You could write about:

- what they look like
- how they are written
- what they say.

[2 marks]

Difference 1 _____

_____

_____

Difference 2 _____

_____

_____

16

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Section B

Read **Source C** and answer **Questions 12** to **17**.

1 2 Look at the language and structure used in **Source C**.

The main purpose of **Source C** is to

A persuade landlords to carry out fire safety checks.
B explain how people renting a home can check that it's safe.
C advise people looking for a new home to buy rather than rent.

Write the correct letter in the box.

Answer ☐

[1 mark]

1 3 You are advised to use a dictionary for this question.

Source C says: '…there are over 50 000 fires in dwellings in the UK.'

In this quotation the word 'dwellings' means

A homes.
B shops.
C buildings.
D offices.

Write the correct letter in the box.

Answer ☐

[1 mark]

1 4 What does 'Furniture must be fire-resistant' mean?

A Furniture must not be placed near a fire.
B Furniture must not be allowed to block exits and escape routes.
C Furniture must be made of materials which won't catch fire.
D People should not smoke cigarettes near furniture.

Write the correct letter in the box.

Answer ☐

[1 mark]

Do not write outside the box

1 5 Using the information in **Source C**, put a tick (✓) in the correct box to show whether each statement is **true** or **false**.

	True	False
People who own their own home are less likely to have a fire.		
Smoke alarms should be installed on the floor.		
Fire safety checks will prevent fires from happening.		
The law says landlords must fit a carbon monoxide detector.		

[2 marks]

1 6 Using the information in **Source C**, put a tick (✓) in the correct box to show whether each statement is **fact** or **opinion**.

	Fact	Opinion
Each year around 300 people die in fires in homes.		
Moving into your own home is a wonderful experience.		
Your landlord must ensure that there is a safe way out of the property.		
Fire in their home may well be the thing people fear most.		

[2 marks]

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1 7 You are going to rent your first home. You have been advised to make sure your new home is safe from fire.

From **Source C**, make a list of **questions** to ask your landlord to ensure all the fire safety requirements have been met.

[3 marks]

10

END OF QUESTIONS

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There are no questions printed on this page

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ANSWER IN THE SPACES PROVIDED

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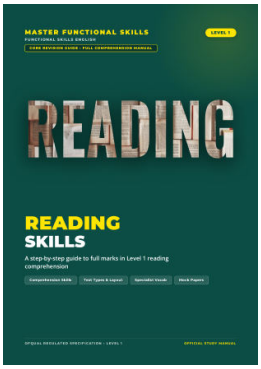
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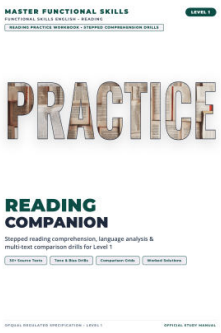


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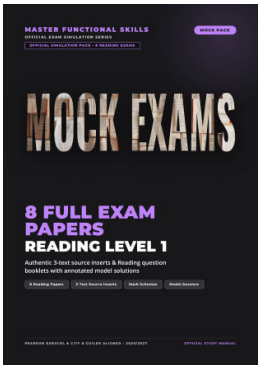


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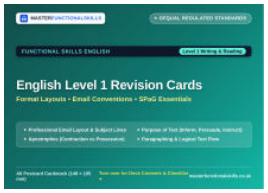


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